

EVICTIION PROCESS — IL

For: John Doe

Understanding the process reduces fear and helps you prepare. This is a general timeline — your specific dates are on your summons.

1. Notice *(5-30 days)*

Landlord serves written notice (5-day, 10-day, or 30-day depending on reason).

2. Complaint Filed *(After notice)*

Landlord files eviction complaint. You are served with summons.

3. File Appearance & Answer *(By return date)*

YOU ARE HERE. You must appear and file answer by the return date on summons.

4. Trial *(Within 14 days)*

Judge hears both sides. Illinois has a right-to-counsel program in some counties.

5. Judgment *(Day of trial)*

If you lose, the judge issues an eviction order.

6. Enforcement *(Varies)*

Sheriff serves eviction order. You typically have a few days to vacate.

IMPORTANT: This timeline is a general guide. Your specific deadlines and procedures depend on your state, county, and case type. Read your summons carefully. If you do not understand something, ask the court clerk or a legal aid attorney.

IMPORTANT: This document is provided for informational purposes only. It is not legal advice. If you need legal advice, contact a licensed attorney.
You are responsible for your own case and what you say in court.